

In the Garden God Made

Unit 1 · Pillar 1: Design · Chamomile, for soothed skin and calm

I have given you every plant yielding seed; it shall be food for you.

Genesis 1:29

WEEK AT A GLANCE

- MONDAY** Read “Life Force” – Gracie’s cut heals by God’s design; meet chamomile.
- TUESDAY** Chamomile discovery – look close, sketch the daisy
- WEDNESDAY** Steep chamomile flowers – count 5 min, taste
- THURSDAY** Egypt’s Nile – paint chamomile suns
- FRIDAY** Sow chamomile seeds; review the week together

Subjects woven this week: Bible · Science ·
ELA · Math · Art · History · Geography · Latin ·
Health · Character

AROUND THE TABLE

*When are you gentlest with
someone small?*

KITCHEN LAB - SUPPLIES NEEDED

- Dried chamomile flowers
- Hot water
- Mug
- Honey
- Small cup + soil
- Chamomile seeds
- Crayons or colored pencils
- Sketchbook



Chamomile

Matricaria chamomilla

Read-Aloud & Discussion

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Chamomile

Foundations - Senses & Skin

MONDAY ORIENTATION

This week's story is "Life Force." Read it aloud together – Gracie pricks her finger in the garden and discovers something astonishing: her body begins to close the cut all by itself, before anyone helps. Vovó shows her that God built that healing in from the very beginning. Our herb this week is chamomile, a small daisy-like flower long brewed into a gentle, calming tea. As your child listens, talk about a time their own body mended – a scrape that closed, a bruise that faded away. Wonder together: who taught your body to do that? God gave us every plant for good, and made us, from the start, to heal.

KEY CONCEPT

God gave you skin to care for, and gave chamomile gentle flowers to soothe it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Gracie's cut began to heal before anyone helped – how did her body know what to do?
2. What has mended in you – a scrape, a bruise – without you even noticing?
3. I wonder, why would God make our bodies able to heal themselves?

MEMORY VERSE

I have given you every plant yielding seed; it shall be food for you.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

*Chamomile, a daisy small
Gold and gentle, soft and mild
It can calm and soothe us all
Rest a tummy, rest a child*

Today's threads: Bible • Language Arts • Character

TEACHER NOTES

LITTLE SPROUTS

Let them watch the tea steep, count the minutes on their fingers, then smell it. Just watch and smell.

OLDER SPROUTS

Have them retell, in their own words, how Gracie's cut healed itself – then draw the tiny 'wall' her blood built.

TODAY'S WORD:

CALM – a settled, peaceful state of body and mind, the opposite of being wound up tight.

How woven – Bible: meeting the memory verse, Genesis 1:29, that God gave every plant for our good; Language Arts: your child hears "Life Force" and retells how Gracie's cut healed; Character: wonder – we learn to marvel at the body's quiet, designed work. Chamomile supports a calm body, a small picture of the peace God built into us from the start.

Discovery

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Chamomile

Foundations - Senses & Skin

DISCOVERY LESSON

Some flowers are so small they could hide behind a button, and chamomile is one. Set a dried chamomile flower in your child's palm and look close: white petals ring a round, golden middle that rises like a tiny dome. Some say it looks like a little sun, others a fried egg – let your child decide. Rub a flower gently and breathe in the sweet, apple-like smell, which is how chamomile earned a name meaning 'earth-apple.' Feel how light and papery the dried petals are. Ask your child to tell back what they saw and smelled. The same God who hung a sun in the sky tucked a tiny one into this gentle flower.

CORE QUESTION:

Look closely at a chamomile flower – what does its middle remind you of?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Look: white petals around a golden dome.
2. Decide: a little sun, or a fried egg?
3. Smell: the sweet, apple-like scent.
4. Name it: chamomile is gentle and calming.
5. Say today's word, NERVINE – a word for herbs that calm the nerves.

NATURE NOTEBOOK

Draw a chamomile flower; label the white petals and gold middle.
Say it: *Matricaria chamomilla* – 'chamomile' means earth apple.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

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Rest a tummy, rest a child*

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

NERVINE – an herb that calms and steadies the nerves.

How woven –

Science: observing a flower's petals and center;

Art: a labeled sketch in the Nature

Notebook;

Language Arts: a new vocabulary word;

Latin: its name, *Matricaria*.

Kitchen Lab

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HERB

Chamomile

Foundations - Senses & Skin

KITCHEN LAB

Today's Kitchen Lab is a cup of chamomile tea – another infusion, just like last week. We measure the little dried flowers, pour hot water, and let them steep until the water turns pale gold and smells of apples. Made and enjoyed the same day.

TEACHING NOTE

A same-day lab: brew and taste today, then pour the rest out. A grown-up always handles the hot water and lets the tea cool before your child sips.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Measure 1 tsp of dried chamomile flowers into a mug.
2. Pour 8 oz of hot water over them.
3. Cover and steep 5 minutes.
4. Strain out the flowers.
5. Add a little honey if you like; cool, then smell and taste.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear says: Chamomile is gentle, but it is a daisy cousin. If anyone sniffles around daisies or ragweed, check with a grown-up first.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

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Today's threads: Science • Math • Health

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:
INFUSION – a tea made by soaking flowers or leaves in hot water.
How woven –
Science: hot water pulls the flowers' gold color and apple scent into the cup;
Math: measure and time the 5-minute steep;
Health: a warm cup helps the body slow down.

History & Art

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Chamomile

Foundations - Senses & Skin

HISTORY LESSON

On the wide green banks of the Nile, in ancient Egypt, the sun blazed bright and hot. There, thousands of years ago, people loved the little chamomile flower. Its golden center and white petals reminded them of the sun, so they treasured it as a sun-herb. Egyptian healers are said to have brewed its gentle flowers to calm and comfort the body. Picture a blossom so small you could hide it behind your thumb, yet loved by a whole great kingdom! It reminds us that God often tucks His best gifts into the smallest, humblest packages – and gives us eyes to notice them.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

Every plant began at Creation, the third day God spoke (Genesis 1:11-12). Around 1500 BC, Egyptians along the Nile prized chamomile as a golden sun-herb to calm and comfort – a gentle flower loved since the world's oldest gardens.

ART ACTIVITY

1. Draw a large golden circle for the Egyptian sun.
2. Around it, paint many small chamomile flowers like little suns.
3. Give each white petals around a gold center.
4. Add a Nile-blue border with simple Egyptian patterns.
5. Title it 'Egypt's Sun-Herb' and sign your name.

ON THE MAP

Find Egypt and the Nile River in Africa. Long ago, people there grew chamomile in the warm Nile valley sunshine.

CHAMOMILE CHANT

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Today's threads: History • Geography • Art • Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

HEALER – someone who uses God's plants to help the body mend.

How woven –

History: chamomile in ancient Egypt;
Geography: Egypt and the Nile on the map;

Art: an Egyptian sun-disk of chamomile flowers;

Language Arts: hearing and retelling the history.

Garden & Review

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Foundations - Senses & Skin

GARDEN ACTIVITY

1. Fill a small cup with soil and pat it gently flat.
2. Scatter a pinch of tiny chamomile seeds over the top.
3. Press them gently onto the soil; do not cover them – these tiny seeds need light to sprout.
4. Set the cup on a sunny windowsill and keep the soil damp.
5. In a week or two, watch for tiny green sprouts – chamomile is hardy and grows easily!

NEXT WEEK

Next week: lemon balm – bright, lemony leaves that gladden the heart.

WEEK REVIEW

1. What does chamomile's gentle calm help your body do?
2. We brewed chamomile and sprouted its seeds. What surprised you?
3. God gave a tiny flower the power to calm us. What can you thank Him for?
4. Chamomile is hardy and easy to grow. Who could you plant some for?

MEMORY VERSE RECAP

Recite Genesis 1:29

CHAMOMILE CHANT

*Chamomile, a daisy small
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Rest a tummy, rest a child*

Vovó says: Even the smallest flower was made to bring us peace.

Today's threads: Science • Language Arts • Bible

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

HARDY – strong and easy to grow, even in tough conditions.

How woven –

Science: sowing hardy chamomile seeds on the surface for light;

Language Arts: retelling the week's review questions;

Bible: reciting Genesis 1:29 with Vovó's blessing.

WORKS CITED

King's American Dispensatory (Felter & Lloyd, 1898),
'Matricaria' • POWO,
Matricaria chamomilla • NCCIH, Chamomile • NASB Genesis 1:29

FURTHER READING

Rosemary Gladstar's Medicinal Herbs: A Beginner's Guide – Rosemary Gladstar (parent read; take the sound herb-craft, discern and leave the 'plant spirit' spirituality of her wider work)

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Math•R3 – measure 1 tsp & time the steep
Science•R2 – observe a flower's parts

Art•R3 – botanical sketch

Geography•R2 – locate Egypt/the Nile